UI & UX DESIGN ADVANCED DESIGN FUNDAMENTALS WITH FIGMA

MODULE 3: DESIGN PROCESS AND AUDIENCE RESEARCH

1. **Understanding a Design Brief**
    - A **design brief** is a document that outlines the **project goals, requirements, constraints, and expectations**.
    - Key elements in a brief:
        - Project objectives
        - Target audience
        - Platform (web, mobile, etc.)
        - Brand guidelines (colors, typography, logo use)
        - Functional requirements (features, screens, interactions)
    - Purpose: Helps designers stay **focused, consistent, and aligned with client goals**.
2. **User Research and Target Audience**
    - **User research** involves understanding the **needs, behaviors, and goals** of the users.
    - Methods include: surveys, interviews, observation, and online research.
    - **Target audience**: The specific group of users who will interact with your app or website.
        - Consider age, occupation, interests, tech literacy, and location.
    - Purpose: Ensures the design is **relevant, usable, and engaging** for the intended users.
3. **Paper Wireframing**
    - **Wireframes** are simple, low-fidelity sketches that show **screen layouts and content placement**.
    - Paper wireframing allows **quick brainstorming and iteration** without focusing on visual details.
    - Focus on: layout, hierarchy, navigation flow, and placement of buttons/fields.
4. **Translating Paper Wireframes to Digital Screens**

- Once paper wireframes are finalized, they are recreated in a **digital design tool** like Figma or Adobe XD.
- Steps:
  - Create **frames/artboards** matching each screen.
  - Place **shapes and text elements** according to the paper wireframe.
  - Keep it **low-fidelity** (basic shapes, placeholders, minimal styling).
- Purpose: Prepares for **prototyping and high-fidelity design** later.

Practical Tasks

1. **Conduct Mini-Audience Research**
   - Identify a small group of users for your app concept.
   - Ask 3–5 questions to understand their **needs, pain points, and expectations**.
   - Example questions:
     - "What apps do you use daily?"
     - "What frustrates you about similar apps?"
     - "What feature would you like most in this app?"
2. **Design a Low-Fidelity Wireframe for a Sample App**
   - Choose a sample app concept (e.g., To-Do List, Food Delivery, or Login Screen).
   - Sketch **paper wireframes** for the main screens (Home, Login, Menu).
   - Transfer the sketches to **Figma or Adobe XD** as **digital wireframes**:
     - Add **frames/artboards**
     - Draw **basic shapes** for buttons, input fields, and images
     - Add **placeholder text**

Example Task

- **Sample App:** Mobile To-Do List

1. **Paper Wireframe:**
    - Home screen: list of tasks, “Add Task” button
    - Add Task screen: input field, save button
2. **Digital Wireframe in Figma:**
    - Create **frames** for Home and Add Task screens
    - Add **rectangles for task items**, **circle for checkboxes**, and **buttons**
    - Use **text placeholders** like “Task Name” or “Save”
    - Align elements using **grids and snapping**

✅ By completing this module, you will understand **how to interpret a design brief, research your audience, and create initial low-fidelity wireframes**, forming the foundation for a user-centered design process.